

Document: Parliament seeks bigger transport budget, 'Buy European' rules

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By Martina Sapio · Jul 14, 2026, 5:45 PM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — The European Parliament want to significantly rewrite the EU's next Connecting Europe Facility, boosting funding for transport and military mobility and introducing a "Buy European" clause for strategic infrastructure, according to draft compromise amendments dated July 10 and obtained by POLITICO.

The CEF, the EU's flagship infrastructure funding program, finances cross-border transport, energy and military mobility projects. As negotiations on the bloc's next long-term budget intensify, the Parliament is proposing increasing the facility's budget for 2028-2034 from the Commission's proposed €81.4 billion to €91.3 billion, including almost €38 billion for transport, €19.8 billion for military mobility and €33.5 billion for energy.

The compromise also mentions a new "Union preference" provision, allowing EU funding to favour technologies and suppliers from the bloc for strategically important transport, energy and military mobility projects where justified by security or resilience concerns.

The draft also broadens the range of transport investments eligible for funding, placing greater emphasis on rail-road terminals, urban nodes, last-mile connections, alternative fuel infrastructure, port electrification, onshore power supply and digital rail technologies such as the European Rail Traffic Management System.

An accompanying annex lists the cross-border projects Parliament wants prioritized under the program, including Rail Baltica, the Lyon-Turin rail link, the Brenner Base Tunnel, the Fehmarn Belt crossing, the Iron Ore Line, Marseille-Nice-Genoa, and dozens of other rail, inland waterway and port projects across the bloc.

Negotiators from Parliament's transport and industry committees are due to meet on Wednesday to discuss the compromise package before moving on to the next batch of amendments.

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